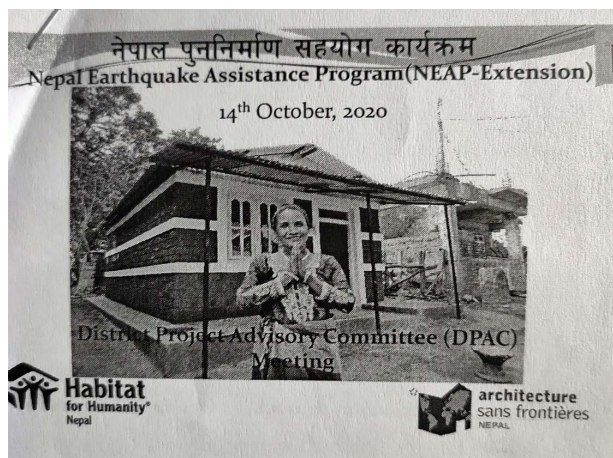




The District Project Advisory Committee (DPAC) meeting of the Nepal Earthquake Assistance Program (NEAP) project, implemented by Habitat for Humanity through ASF Nepal from January 2019 to September 2020, was held on 14 October 2020 in Dhulikhel. The DPAC meeting discussed the lessons learned and accomplishments of the project including sustainable development, and further support to most vulnerable households and hand over to local government as part of localization of reconstruction procedures.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **HRRP Team would like to wish a very Happy Dashain 2020 to all !**
- **Save date for virtual Nepal and Asia Region Reconstruction and Shelter Experience” from 27-29 November 2020**
- **[Interest subsidized loan procedural guideline-third amendment 2077](#)**
- **[COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population \(MoHP\)](#)**
- **The Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) update**
- **Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee Meeting update**
- **Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster Meeting update**

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Abinash Amar, Focal Engineer



Abinash Amar

*Focal Engineer, Mahankal Rural
Municipality, Lalitpur*

Abinash Amar has been working as the focal engineer of Mahankal Rural Municipality of Lalitpur district. When Abinash led the reconstruction, the reconstruction work reached to 80% from 40%. He concentrated on completing all the reconstruction tasks of Kaleshwor village of the rural municipality within December 2019 and declared it as the first reconstructed ward within the Kathmandu valley.

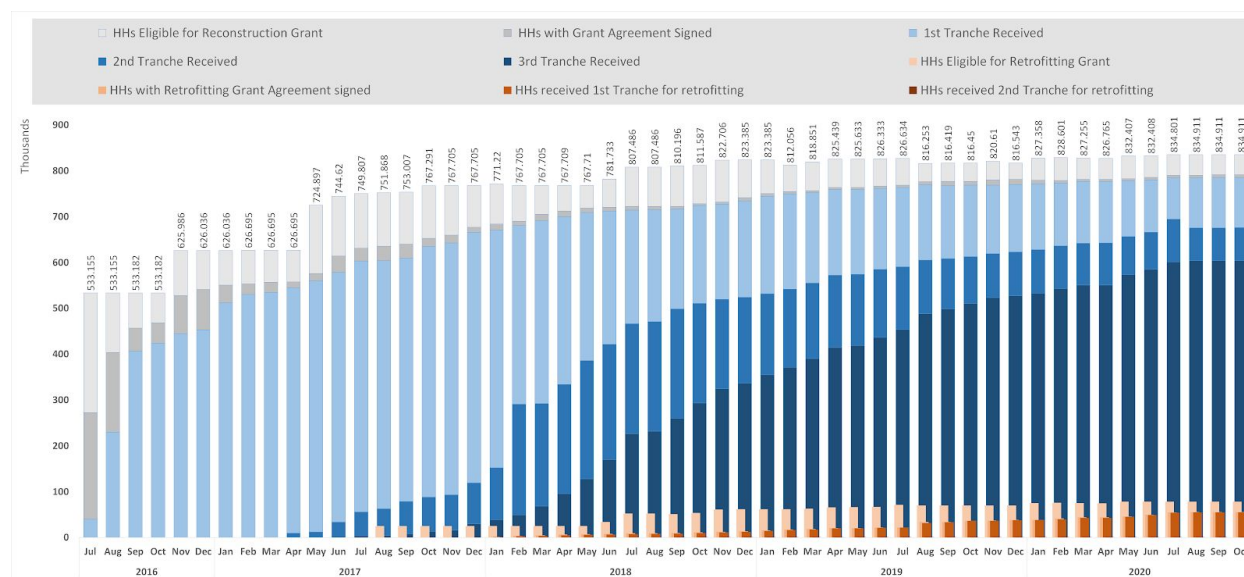
However, he encountered numerous challenges in this reconstruction journey; the reconstruction beneficiaries' name was absent in the NRA grant list and the grievance list. These problems were sorted out after having a candid meeting with the local government and other NRA authorities. He also led the engineering movement and protest since the start of March 2019 demanding the protection of their rights.

NATIONAL UPDATES

[NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 19 October 2020:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	31 August	28 September	19 October
Total No. Eligible HHs	834911	834911	834911
HHs Enrolled	790260	791334	791534
HHs Received 1st Tranche	784520	784535	784556
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	675454	675457	675613
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	603550	603551	603555
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
Houses Completed	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs with Completion Certificate	N/A	N/A	N/A
Retrofit Grant	31 August	28 September	19 October
Total No. Eligible HHs	78033	78033	78033
HHs Enrolled	55051	55282	55282
HHs Received 1st Tranche	54466	54497	54497
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	302	302	302

**N/A indicates that the information source was not accessible at the time of reporting*



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMAI CLPIU data as of 19 Oct 2020.

Save date for virtual Nepal and Asia Region Reconstruction and Shelter Experience from 27-29 November 2020, National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) and Asia Shelter Forum have fixed the date for “Nepal and Asia Region Reconstruction and Shelter Experience” virtual experience sharing from 27-29 November 2020. This web-based sharing session will focus on experience sharing from Nepal’s reconstruction including shelter and settlement communities of practice around the globe. The first two day will focus on National Reconstruction Authority’s Corporate Paper (Compendium) as part of its institutional memory, covering its 5 years of experience and learning from its oversight and coordination of the reconstruction endeavor post the Gorkha Earthquake of 2015.

The third day, which will be virtual and abridged Asia Shelter Forum, will focus to inform and provide updates on various on- going initiatives on shelter interventions in areas of shelter cluster coordination and its working groups, recovery and preparedness to address particular identified needs based on successes and lessons during implementation in the field aimed at investing in quality humanitarian shelter programming, response and coordination in the Asia Pacific region.

Interest subsidized loan procedural guideline-third amendment 2077, Nepal Rastra Bank has published interest subsidized loan procedural guideline 2077, third amendment for the public consumption.

A Webinar report on “A green recovery-Affordable housing for vulnerable families and resilient livelihoods using CSEB interlocking bricks in Nepal” 02 October 2020:

Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) in collaboration with Build Up Nepal Engineering, Dan Church Aid (DCA), Practical Action & Community Impact Nepal organized a Webinar Session on 02 October 2020 on the subject “A green recovery - Affordable housing for vulnerable families and resilient livelihoods using CSEB interlocking bricks in Nepal”. Mr. Björn Söderberg - Founder of Build Up Nepal Engineering; Mr. Deepak Hamal, the President of Interlocking Bricks Association of Nepal and the proprietor of Easy Bricks, Palung, Makwanpur; and Mr. Dadhiraj Pudasaini, Indrasarovar Interlocking Bricks Udhog presented papers on CSEB and discussed on the comparative advantages of CSEB, its benefit and support in low cost housing reconstruction solutions along with environment protection by reducing CO2 emission including entrepreneurship skill development at the local level. Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, Executive Committee Member of NRA and Er. Shyam Kishor Singh, Project Director of CLPIU-Building, provided valuable suggestions to the entrepreneurs, who presented on the manufacturing of CSEB for its reliability and sustainability, contributing to housing reconstruction of vulnerable beneficiaries and other general public at large. Click on the links for [presentation](#), [webinar report](#), [webinar event recording](#).

International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction Day, 13 October 2020: Disaster Preparedness Network-Nepal (DPNet-Nepal), as a secretariat of National Platform for DRR, organized a virtual national symposium on current DRR mitigation plans as part of marking an International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction that began in 1989, after a call by the United Nations General Assembly for a day to promote a global culture of risk-awareness and disaster reduction. On 13 October, the day celebrates how people and communities around the world are reducing their exposure to disasters and raising awareness about the importance of reining in the risks that they face.

The Urban Recovery Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) update:

The UR-TWG held its 17th meeting on 15 October, 2020. The agenda of the meeting was: a) Sharing of progress on urban quantitative assessment report and gather suggestions from partners b) Brainstorming on further activities that UR-TWG can undertake c) Sharing of

progress and updates in urban recovery by UR-TWG members d) Dashain greetings exchange.

Ms. Sneha Malani (Urban Recovery Advisor from HRRP Nepal) updated members on the urban housing recovery quantitative assessment, and the key findings from the analysis were shared in the meeting. The UR-TWG and NRA jointly conducted a quantitative assessment on urban housing recovery in August 2020, covering 818 households in urban wards across 6 earthquake-affected districts. The data analysis has been carried out and the first draft of the report is ready. The report is currently in review stage and the final report will be published next month. A short brainstorming session was conducted to plan further activities based on urban housing recovery issues identified during UR-TWG's qualitative and quantitative studies. For more information, please contact, Urban Coordination Officer, Mr. Rupesh Shrestha: uco@hrrpnepal.org

Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster update, 15 October 2020:

The third virtual meeting of the Bagmati Province Shelter Cluster was organized on 15 October 2020. The meeting focused on discussing monsoon effects, damage and loss caused by the monsoon and coverage of partners' support for the affected population including situation update on of COVID-19 and status of isolation and quarantine facilities in Bagmati province. You can access all the meeting minutes, cluster presentation and other related resources on the Bagmati Shelter Cluster [here](#). For more information, contact Mr. Rijan Gajurel (Hub Coordinator), rijan.gajurel@hrrpnepal.org; mobile number: 9843217112.

COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

According to the Ministry of Health & Population (MOHP) [website](#) data, as of 18 October 2020, total cumulative new cases are 132,246 (male- 91,247 and female- 40,999), out of which 39,341 confirmed cases are undergoing medical treatment in isolation and 92,166 are discharged after recovery. So far 739 have died due to COVID-19 in Nepal. There are a total of 4,831 in quarantine facilities.

The MoHP has operationalized two call centers **1115 (from 6 am to 10 pm)** and **1133 (24 hours)** to provide counselling services regarding COVID-19 prevention and treatment.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Lalitpur**, out of total 737 vulnerable beneficiaries, 449 have received first tranche. Nearly 30 beneficiaries were supported by POs such as Lumanti, Batas Foundation, ICDO, SOH and Maya Foundation and have provided top up support of construction materials. All POs projects have phased out and are not supporting the reconstruction.

In **Bhaktapur**, out of 1,035 total vulnerable beneficiaries, 860, have received first tranche while only 176 have accessed second tranche and 159 of them have completed housing reconstruction. There is no POs support in Bhaktapur district and the beneficiaries themselves have initiated reconstruction.

In **Dolakha**, the District Coordination Committee organized a coordination meeting on 15 October 2020 to discuss quarterly performance monitoring of local level and financial management for development activities in Bhimeshwar Municipality. Bhimeshwar Municipality is planning to operate 184 schemes this year and 11 plans will be operated through the bid. Orientation on all the 184 schemes has been completed by the committee. The agreement of the entire planned schemes bids will be completed within the month of Kartik, 2077 BS. The District Coordination Committee has planned to perform the bids on time.

In **Kathmandu**, GMaLI has started collecting the missing PA number from banks and other stakeholders with support from technical staff where Finance consultant and MIS Specialist are taking the lead. Legal appeal process that was halted due to prohibitory order in Kathmandu has been reopened. All the beneficiaries who have either missed the RS/RV or listed as non-beneficiary and are not satisfied with the result are allowed to go through the legal process. Results of which will be notified before the end of Ashwin 2077 (16 October 2020). Of the 263 cases that have been filed, 62 have been declared as reconstruction beneficiaries and 1 as retrofitting while others are still waiting for the result. In total 162 people have requested for the conversion of their beneficiary types. GMaLI is tracking tranche duplication and double payment of beneficiaries supported by POs and the Government and is in the process of getting back the tranche. Tranche duplication tracking of 10 beneficiaries of Chandragiri Municipality – 4 and Gokarneshwor Municipality- 6 supported by Himalaya Dana Foundation has been completed. Concerned ward offices and beneficiaries have been contacted in this regard and have been encouraged to return the tranche amount. DLPIU Building has mobilized social mobilizers and mobile masons to track one to one details of beneficiaries that have either not signed the partnership agreement or have received the first or second tranche and have not completed the

reconstruction. In regards to the sorting of first, second and third tranche inspection files that is undergoing in all municipalities, only Tokha Municipality has been completed.

In **Kavrepalanchok**, the District Project Advisory Committee (DPAC) meeting was organized by Habitat for Humanity and its local implementing partner ASF on 14 October 2020. The meeting was attended by authorized representatives of District Coordination Committee, GMaLI chief, DLPIU-building focal engineer, Palika and ward chairpersons, HRRP team, and district journalist. DPAC shared learnings, experiences, and challenges during the reconstruction process. Discussion focused on completing the remaining reconstruction in the working areas, identification and providing support to vulnerable HHs, and handover to municipalities and localization processes. Habitat for Humanity/ASF noted that their Nepal Earthquake Assistance Program (NEAP) that incorporated social mobilization, technical assistance and stepwise support in close coordination with all the Government stakeholders and partner organizations has been successfully completed. They have also worked out the handover mechanism of equipment and materials to municipalities such that the materials could be used by all the beneficiaries inside the district. GMaLI thanked HfH/ASF for their contribution in supporting reconstruction of vulnerable HHs and communities.

In **Makwanpur**, the meeting with GMaLI chief, and M&E was held on 9 October 2020 to discuss identification and support to the vulnerable beneficiaries. The meeting also had discussion over the house reconstructed by CCDN in Thaha and Kailash municipalities based on NRA guidelines. Data management works are in the final stage and it is hoped that this will help local levels to keep track of their data in an easier and proper way. Further, grant recommendation works are going on which has helped to move the reconstruction ahead.

In **Lamjung**, the team visited the DLPIU - GMaLI office on 28 September 2020 to discuss the vulnerable issues. The GMaLI chief informed that municipalities and rural municipalities of the district have not verified the vulnerable list due to which there is no progress in the additional top-up support provided to the vulnerable beneficiaries. On 6 October 2020, the meeting at the DLPIU building was held to discuss the reconstruction issues and challenges faced from the technical perspective. The issues of vulnerable beneficiaries were also discussed, where the majority of the DLPIU and the municipal technical informed that they did not have an idea about the vulnerability categorization and its guidelines.

In **Dhading**, the GMaLI has suspended all the services other than the essential services from 8 October 2020 until further notice. The decision has been made in order to curb the further transmission of COVID-19 as the employees of GMaLI were tested positive for COVID-19. Further, the meeting organized by the District Security Committee held on 13 October 2020 has decided to extend the prohibitory order in the district effective from 12 noon of the same day until further notice.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward No. 9, Suryabinayak Municipality, Bhaktapur: Single storey BMC with two-roomed. The homeowner received second tranches of the government housing grant and he has processed for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 2, Kalinchowk Rural Municipality, Dolakha: Stone in mud mortar with RCC bands. The homeowner has received all the subsequent tranche of the government housing grant. Technical support was provided by DLPIU Building and NSET.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 5, Khaniyabas Rural Municipality, Dhading: SMM single story house is under construction. The house owner has received a second tranche of the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 1, Shankharapur Municipality, Kathmandu: One storey load bearing brick in cement structure with CGI roof . The house owner has received all the tranches under the housing reconstruction grant of Nepal Government.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 4, Bethanchowk Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok, Stone in mud mortar. The house owner has received all the three tranches from the government housing grant. The total cost of construction is 600,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 1, Manahari Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Load bearing block house with two rooms and flexible roof. All earthquake resistant elements have been provided. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant. The cost of construction is 700,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung Cluster Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward 2, Sundarbazar Municipality, Lamjung: Single storey brick masonry in cement mortar house is under construction. The house reconstruction is completed up to the gable level and the homeowner is planning to put shade with light CGI roofing. It is a two room compliant house with horizontal and vertical RCC bands at all levels. The house owner has received the second tranche from the NRA.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Solukhumbu Cluster Monthly Report, 25 Sep – 15 Oct 2020



Ward-3, Siddhicharan Municipality, Okhaldhunga: House type stone in mud mortar with RCC band. The house owner received all three tranches and has also received a house completion certificate.

FEATURED STORY



Abinash Amar, Focal Engineer, Mahankal Rural Municipality, Lalitpur : Over the past three years, Abinash Amar has been working as the focal engineer of Mahankal Rural Municipality of Lalitpur district. Though the rural municipality is close to the federal capital 'Kathmandu', it still has many settlements that are deprived of road networks due to which reconstruction works there were still lagging. Abinash further informs that in the monsoon, the roads are not operational due to the puddles and muddy paths

that often created trouble in having access to the center of the rural municipality.

When Abinash led the reconstruction, the reconstruction work reached to 80% from 40%. He concentrated on completing all the reconstruction tasks of Kaleshwor village of the rural municipality within December 2019 and declared it as the first reconstructed ward within the Kathmandu valley. However, he encountered numerous challenges in this reconstruction journey; the reconstruction beneficiaries' name was absent in the NRA grant list and the grievance list. These problems were sorted out after having a candid meeting with the local government and other NRA authorities. The seismic house resistant construction training and the social mobilization training that he received from governmental, non-governmental, and UN agencies helped to deal with the public issues as well as community mobilization.

Furthermore, he also led the engineering movement and protest since the start of March 2019 demanding the protection of their rights. The DLPIU offices across the earthquake-affected districts were padlocked from mid of March 2019. By the end of April 2019, they also announced the mass resignation of all 4,000 engineers and technicians as the NRA did not make any efforts to fulfill their demands. The agitating engineering technicians agreed to return to work after the reconstruction authorities agreed to fulfill their demands. He added that the overall reconstruction work is progressing remarkably.

CASE STORY

Sukumaya Lopchan, Retrofitting (RTB) to Potential (RCB): Sukumaya Lopchan is 32-year-old woman, living in Sailung Rural Municipality, ward no. 7 with her mentally ill husband and a daughter. After the 2015 earthquake, the family went through hell as she not only lost her house but also had immense psychological suffering. Her husband went through mental trauma and became ill after the earthquake. Above all, despite her house being completely damaged, her name was in the NRA list of retrofitting beneficiaries eligible to receive only one lakh as government grant. She had been living in a bamboo cottage with her family with poor financial condition and no money to reconstruct a resilient house. UNDP helped her to construct the house involving neighbors and ward support.





Ms. Lopchan is one of the beneficiaries receiving in-kind support worth Nrs 50,000 and support of 5 masons for 3 days (in the form of training). After her name was recommended and approved from local Ward committee members, she was provided both social and technical support. “without this support, I would have never started nor could reconstruct my house again”, said Ms. Lopchan. According to her, she had started to develop inferiority complex as a result of not being able to have a decent house like her neighbor who had already completed their houses. “I was emotionally weak”, says

Sukumaya, who had no financial support to reconstruct her house. She even went about seeking loan from financial institutions after hearing of the loan provision from Nepal government. But to her surprise, it wasn't as easy as she thought. “They ask for collateral from a poor individual like me, which I didn't have”, shared furiously.

Consequently, she had completely lost her hope of reconstructing the house for the family as her husband was helpless too. The source of income for their family was from daily wage labour that Ms. Lopchan brought from locally available work of other houses. She says when there is work, she can earn NPR 500 a day but when not available, it is really difficult. Even having only about 0.5 ropani of land, it is hard to save money for the future as they are most needed at the mention on a daily basis.

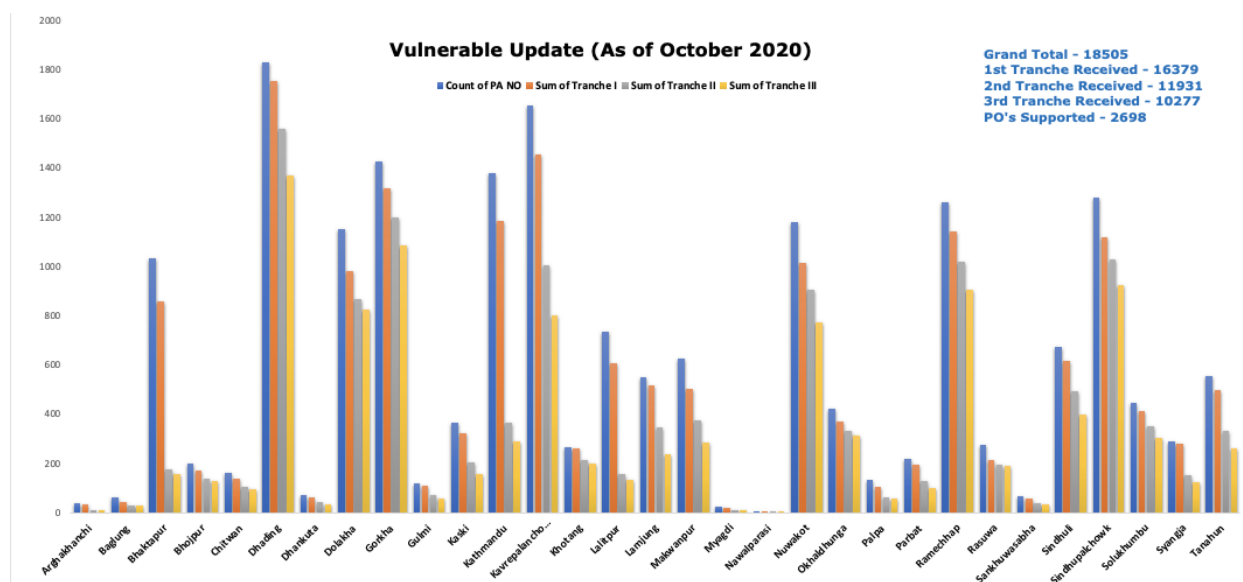


In a situation like this, UNDP with local partners and her neighbors took the initiation to forward her name on the grievance list to change from her initial status of Retrofitting to Potential reconstruction beneficiary (RTB to RCB). However, the local decided to help her start construction until her name is enlisted and becomes eligible for 3 lakhs. Therefore, in addition to in-kind and socio-technical support provided by UNDP, her neighbor contributed in the startup of her housing reconstruction. Though she started the construction, it took her longer time to complete the construction process, resulting from

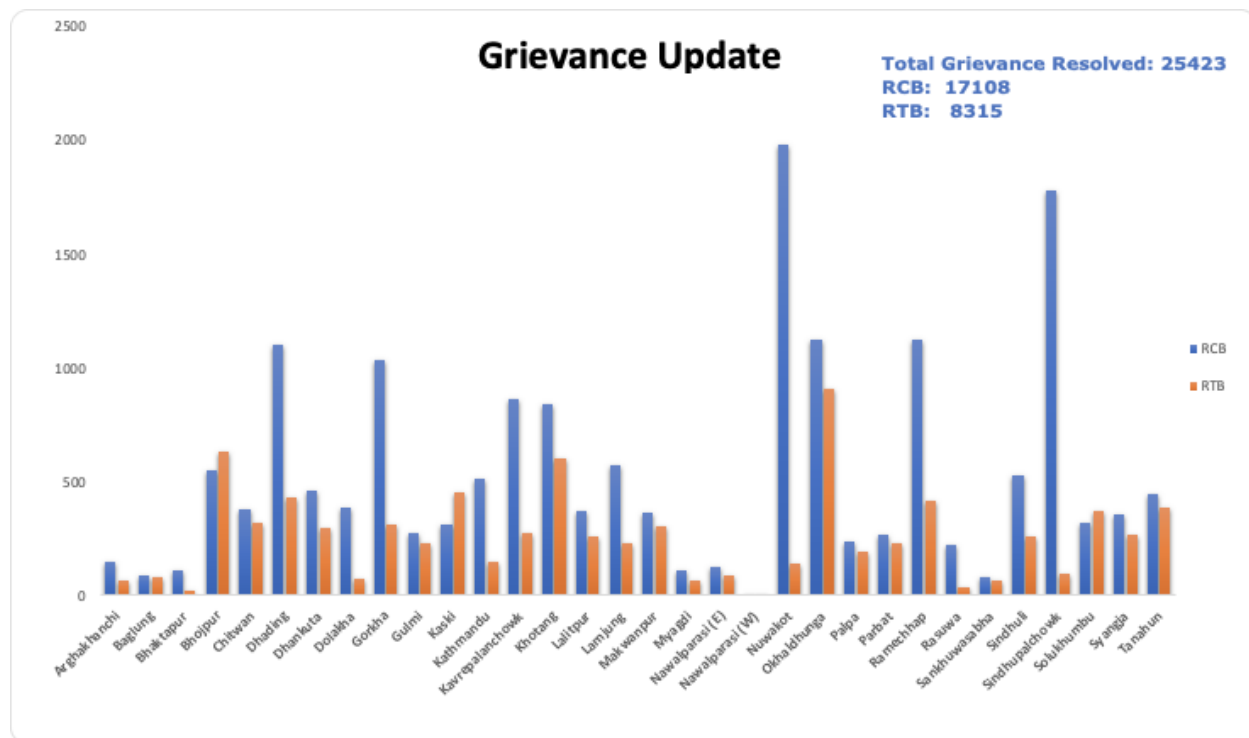
late dispatch of eligible financial claims. Now, she has received all tranches of government grant.

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction (October 2020): Of the total 18,505 NRA identified vulnerable households, 88% (16,379) have received the first tranche, 64% (11,931) have received second tranche and 55% (10,277) have received third tranche. In total 2,698 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



Grievance Update: As of October 2020 , **25,423** grievances have been addressed by NRA of which **17,108** HHs have been enlisted as reconstruction beneficiaries and **8,315** as retrofitting beneficiaries.



MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



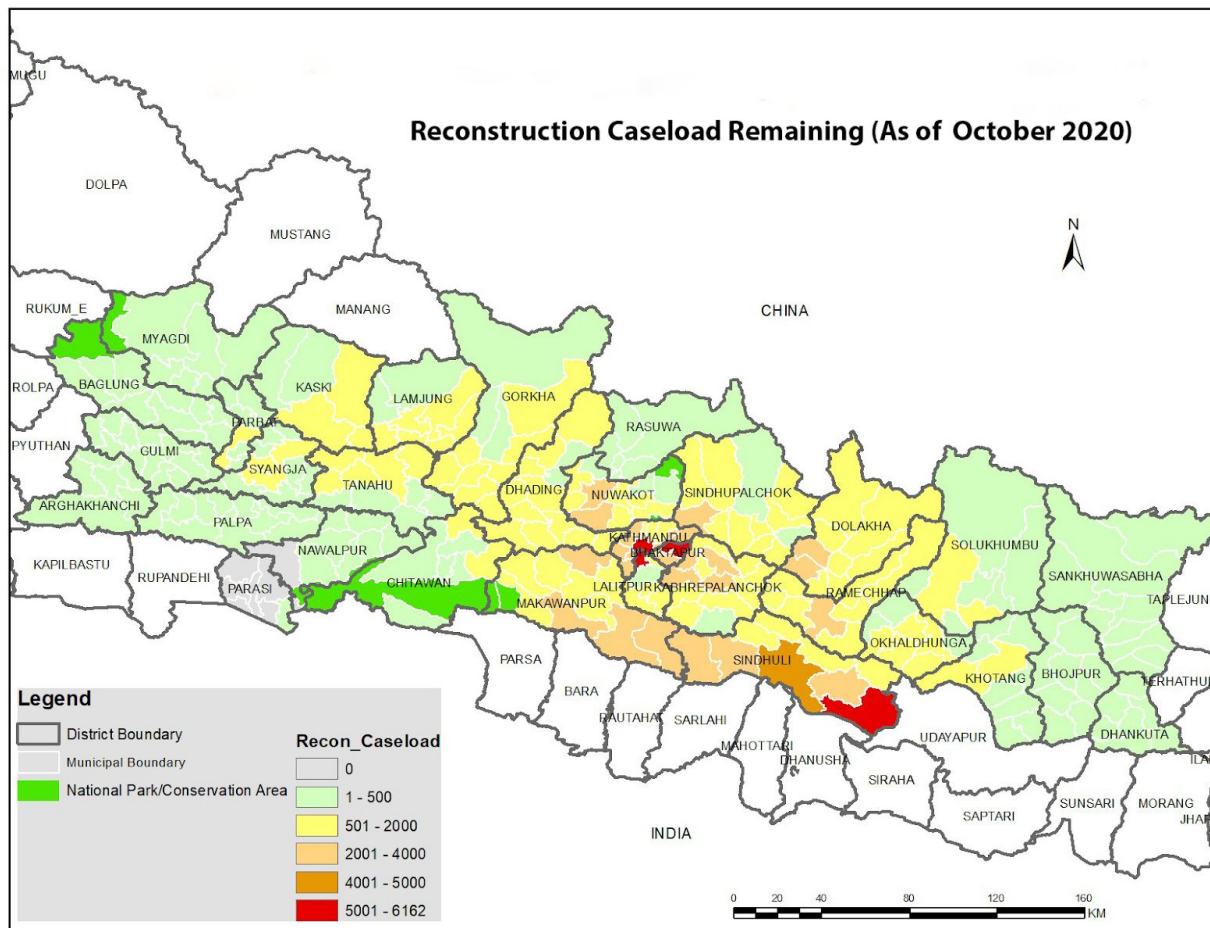
[Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal | 9 October 2020:](#) This episode focused on challenges of reconstruction faced by vulnerable households and their expectation from the government in Kavrepalanchowk district. This program is aired on Nepal Television every Friday 7:00 PM and Every Saturday 10:30 AM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

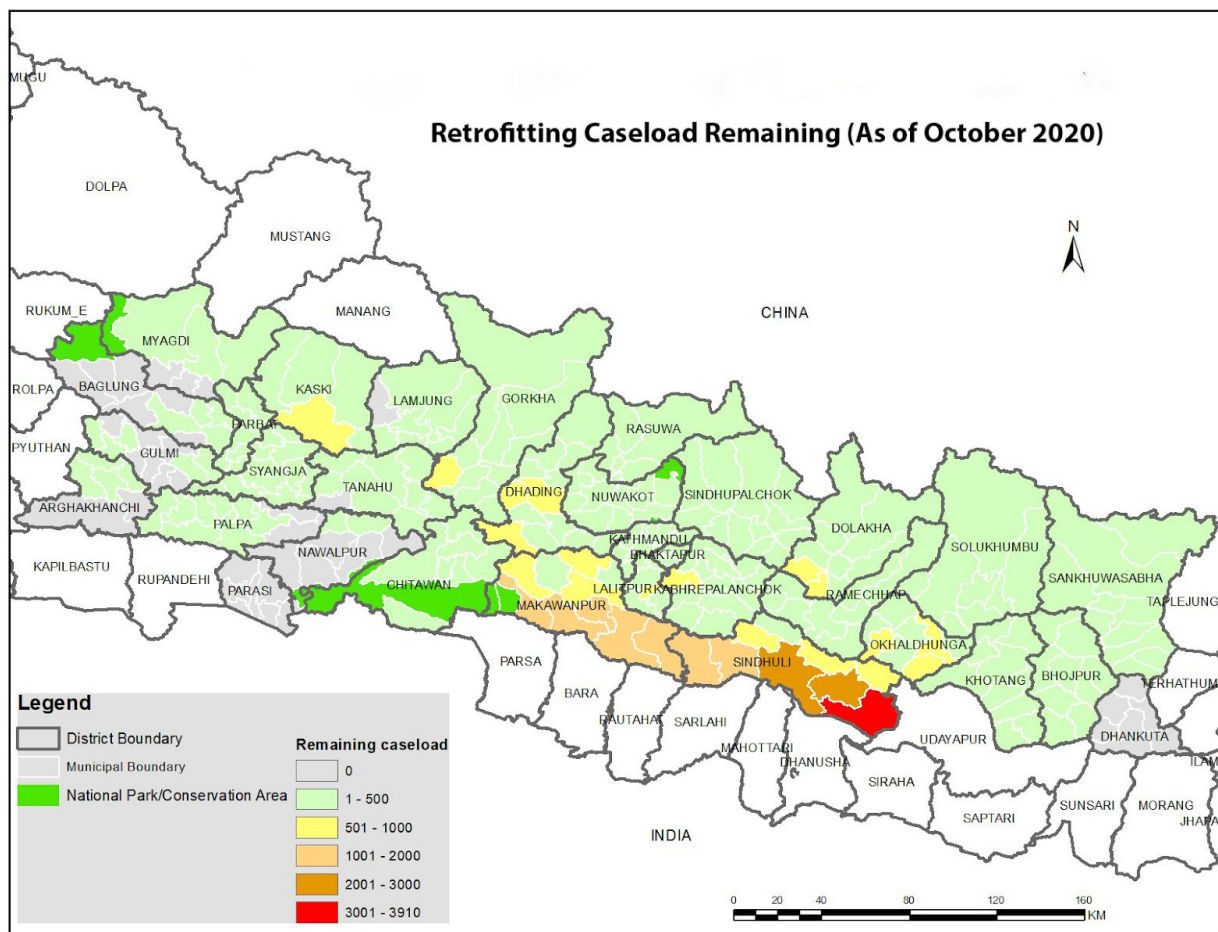
[Monthly e-newsletter of NRA September 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS

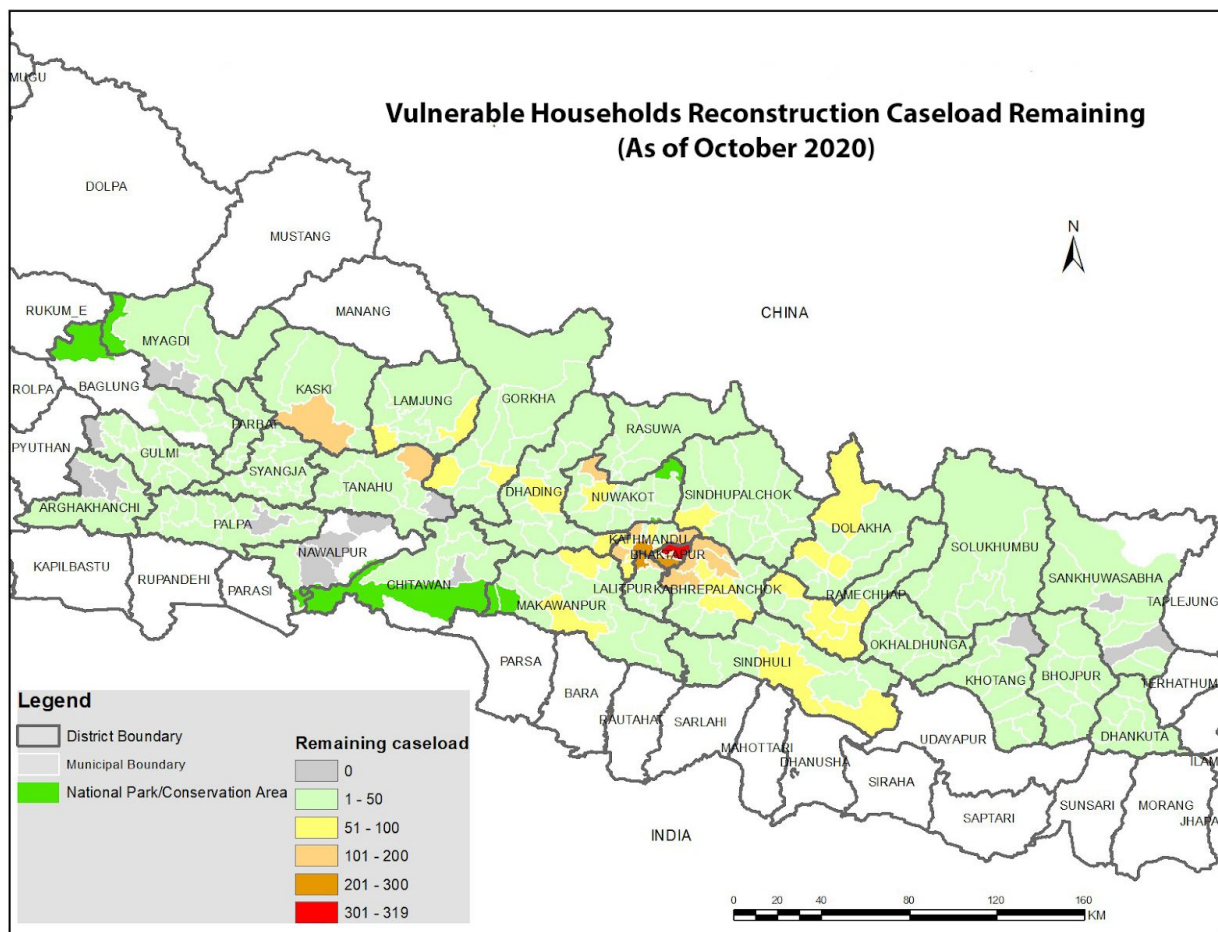
Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (October 2020)



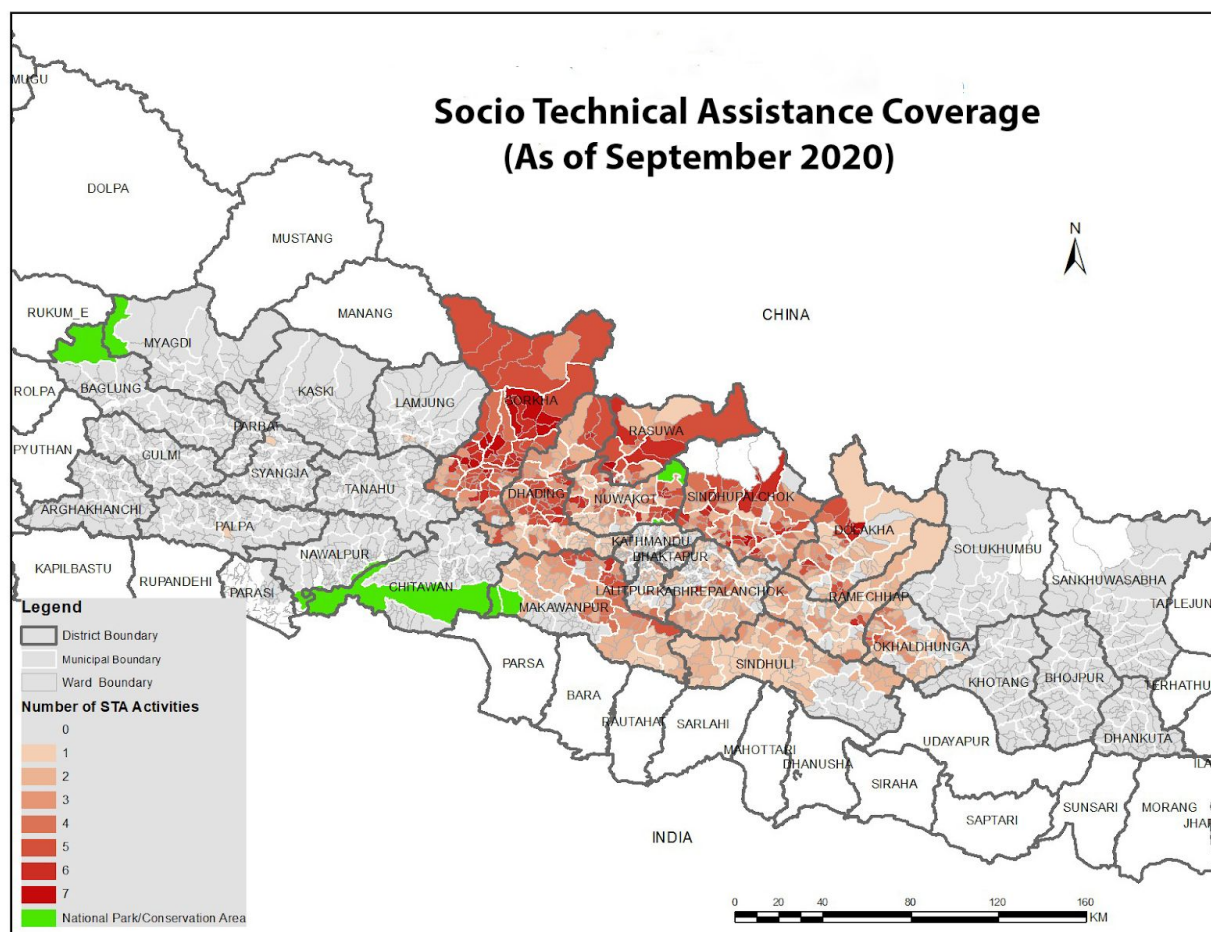
Retrofitting Caseload Remaining (October 2020)



Vulnerable Households Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (October 2020)



Coverage of Socio Technical Assistance (September 2020): This is based on 5W data collection, 10 September 2020.



[Palika Profiles \(Municipal reconstruction profiles\)](#)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



[Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack](#)

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake-affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



[Municipal dataset on Reconstruction](#)

[CSV, PDF](#)

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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Primarily funded by:

